

Chapter 10

The apprehensive function of a final enclitic particle in Baoding (Sinitic)

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This paper aims to examine the apprehensive function of a final enclitic particle =*le.ia* in the Baoding dialect, a Mandarin dialect spoken in Northern China (Sinitic). This particle is restricted to future situations and its main pragmatic function is to require the addressee's involvement in order to avoid a potential undesirable situation. It mainly but not exclusively appears in independent clauses and originally has a temporal function. In this paper, we examine the semantic and syntactic constraints on =*le.ia*, its various functions, and we have a detailed look at the predicates that it co-occurs with. We argue that the apprehensive function of =*le.ia* is a semantic extension of its temporal function as an imminent future marker. We also investigate the possible source of the enclitic particle: =*le.ia* synchronically functions as a single unit but can be traced to two final enclitic particles: the enclitic =*le* which marks change of state, and the enclitic particle =*ia* marking imminent future. These data on the Baoding dialect not only fill a gap in providing detailed data on apprehensional morphology in a broad sense from a Sinitic language, but also point to subtle semantic variations and restrictions in the grammatical expression of undesirability, and to the strong pragmatic expectation on the addressee.

1 Introduction

Languages may have different ways of encoding potential undesirable events which may be more or less grammaticalized. As a general characterization, apprehensive markers are semantically specialized markers that denote a potential event that is considered undesirable. They are also known as a modality that combines both epistemic and attitudinal components (Lichtenberk 1995: 293).



As a category, the apprehensive has not received a lot of attention cross-linguistically, apart from a handful of studies on Austronesian languages (Lichtenberk 1995), Amazonian languages (Vuillermet 2018) and Australian languages (Dixon 2002, Angelo & Schultze-Berndt 2016: 255–296, Verstraete 2005 among others).

Cross-linguistically, apprehensive marking may take the form of an independent word/particle as in To'aba'ita (Lichtenberk 1995) or Northern Australian Kriol (Angelo & Schultze-Berndt 2016), or of an affix as in Yukulta (Keen 1983: 247) or in Ese Ejja (Vuillermet 2018). In Sinitic languages, the apprehensive morpheme can be a modal adverb or a clausal linker as is described for Standard Mandarin (§2.1). In Baoding the apprehensive is primarily expressed by means of a modal enclitic particle (§2.2 and following sections).

An example of a morpheme in apprehensive function as defined above is (1). As noted by Merlan (1983: 102), in Ngalakan, a northern non-Pama–Nyungan language in Australia, the evitative (apprehensive) prefix *mele-* is used in an independent clause expressing some possible event which is deemed undesirable, rather than in a subordinate clause.

- (1) Ngalakan (Gunwinyguan/Ngalakan: Australia; Merlan 1983: 102)
Gu-wol-nowi mele-bolk.
 CLF-smoke-3SG.POSS EVIT-get.out
 'The smoke might come out.'

Green (1989: 168) contrasts the apprehensional constructions in main vs. subordinate clauses in Marrithiyel (a language of the Daly River region of Australia's Northern Territory) by highlighting that in a main clause, the apprehensional marking expresses the speaker's view that the event is undesirable, while in subordinate clauses it expresses the subject's view.

- (2) Marrithiyel (Western Daly, Australia; Green 1989: 80; 170)
Gu-n-ning-pirr-Ø-fang.
 3S.R-go-1SG.O-NSG.NIRR.S-leave-3PL-APPR
 '(I'm afraid) they might leave me.'

In (2), the apprehensive verbal suffix *-fang* appears in a main clause. Leaving may not necessarily correspond to an undesirable situation, but the apprehensive markers actually encodes that, from the speaker's point of view, the event is undesirable. A similar situation is also found in Baoding (see §3.2 and §4). Verstraete (2006: 202) finds that in almost all his examples of Australian languages

the apprehensional construction can be used in a main clause, most typically in warnings.

Another topic which has recently drawn attention is the origin of apprehensional constructions. In Northern Australian Kriol, the temporal particle *bambai* ‘later’ coexists with a homophonous grammaticalized apprehensive particle, which displays a distinct syntactic behaviour in addition to its specialized semantics.

- (3) Kriol (English-lexified creole language, Northern Australia; Angelo & Schultze-Berndt 2016: 269)

- a. *Ai show yu thad lilgel bambai, Denise, yu luk la im.*
 1SG show 2SG DEM girl later NAME 2SG look LOC/ALL 3SG
 ‘I’ll show you (=introduce you to) that girl later, Denise, you’ll see her.’
- b. *Ai gan lad=i yu insaid. Bambai yu dagat mi.*
 1SG CAN.NEG let=TR 2SG inside APPR 2SG eat 1SG
 ‘I won’t let you in. You might eat me.’

Concerning Sinitic languages, there are only few relevant studies, which concern adverbial apprehensional markers that could be grammaticalized from ‘fear’ verbs in Standard Mandarin (Gao 2003). This paper provides data from Baoding, a Mandarin dialect of the Sinitic group.



Figure 1: Location of Baoding, Hebei, China (Song 2020: 27)

Baoding is located in Hebei province (China) and is about 140 km south of Beijing. According to The Language Atlas of China (Maps B 1-3, Liu 2012), the

Baoding dialect belongs to the Jì-lǚ subgroup of Mandarin (a subgroup spoken in a large part of the Hebei province and in the western part of the Shandong province). Although the precise number of Baoding speakers is unknown, we can estimate that about the elder half of the population of the city are likely to speak the Baoding dialect; due to the promotion of Standard Mandarin, younger speakers under 35 have lost their skills in the local language. Despite the geographical proximity of the Baoding dialect and the Beijing dialect, on which Standard Mandarin is based, the Baoding dialect possesses some syntactic features which are quite different from Standard Mandarin, notably in its Tense, Aspect, Modality, and Evidentiality (TAME) system.

The data presented in this article are taken from the author's personal field-work data, gathered during a total of five months in a period extending from 2012 to 2017, which includes elicited sentences, in addition to approximately 40 hours of daily conversation. Our language consultants are around the age of 60 (two females and one male).

In this paper, I will show that besides the adverbial apprehensional markers grammaticalized from 'fear' verbs described for Standard Mandarin (see §2), Baoding may also express apprehension through a final enclitic particle in a main clause. This particle, *=le.ia*, has two main functions: a temporal function, when it encodes an imminent future event, and an apprehensive function with certain types of verbs (see §3.2), which is related to speaker vs. addressee involvement: the particle is used to require the addressee's involvement in order to avoid a potential undesirable situation as illustrated in the following example:

- (4) Baoding
 $\tilde{p}a^{213}$ $tci\tilde{e}^{213-21}$ tia^4 , $t^{h}i\tilde{o}^{213-21}$ *=le.ia*.
 tie fasten a.little fall=**APPR**
 'Tie it up a little bit, it's falling!' (Context: The speaker requires her husband to tie up the flour bag (25kg) at the back of his bicycle when she sees the bag is falling.)

This paper is structured as follows: the current section has provided a general overview of the apprehensive as a cross-linguistic category. §2 presents the apprehensive morphemes in Standard Mandarin and a similar strategy in Baoding. After introducing the TAME system and the final enclitics in Baoding, §3 focuses on the apprehensive function of *=le.ia*, its distribution, and the predicates with which it co-occurs. §4 analyses the semantic contribution of *=le.ia*. §5 discusses how *=le.ia* interacts with person and with sentence type (polar questions). §6 proposes a hypothesis on the source of *=le.ia* and tries to give an account of the

semantic and pragmatic links between its temporal and apprehensive functions. §7 concludes and gives some further perspectives on the motivation for this semantic change.

2 Apprehensional constructions in Sinitic Languages

2.1 Apprehensive morphemes in Standard Mandarin

In Sinitic Languages, apprehensive morphemes have been described for Standard Mandarin by Gao (2003), with reference to Lichtenberk's (1995) study. She describes three morphemes which could have an apprehensional use: *pà*, *kàn* and *bié*, whose respective sources are a 'fear' verb, a 'see' verb, and a prohibitive marker. The following examples (5a) and (5b) illustrate the lexical and grammatical uses, respectively, of *pà* in Standard Mandarin:

(5) Standard Mandarin (Sinitic, Sino-Tibetan; Gao 2003)

- a. 老鼠怕猫。
Lǎoshǔ pà māo.
mouse fear cat
'A mouse fears cats.'
- b. 老没见赵老师露面，怕是叫外国人请去演讲了。
Lǎo méi jiàn Zhào lǎoshī lòumiàn, pà shì jiào wàiguórén qǐng
always NEG see prof.Zhao show.up POT be PASS foreigner invite
qù yǎnjiǎng le.
go give.a.lecture COS
'(I) have not seen Prof. Zhao put in an appearance. He might be away on an invitation by foreigners to give a lecture.'
- c. 红云软软的说着，怕他不明白。
Hóngyún ruǎnrǎnde shuō, pà tā bù míngbai.
Hongyun gently speak APPR 3SG NEG understand
'Hongyun speaks gently, lest he does not understand.'

Example (5c) illustrates the apprehensional use of *pà*: the morpheme has undergone a process of decategorialization (Hopper & Traugott 1993: 104) and it is on the way of the grammaticalization into a general potential modal adverb.

The prohibitive adverb *bié* meaning 'do not do something' as in (6a) can be also employed to mark the apprehensive as shown in (6b):

(6) Standard Mandarin (Sinitic, Sino-Tibetan; Gao 2003)

- a. 别着急。

Bié zháojí.

NEG_{PROH} worry

‘Don’t worry.’

- b. 看看去，别是一楼下水道又堵了。

Kànkān qu, bié shì yīlóu xiàshuǐdào yòu dǔ le.

look.RED go APPR be first.floor sewer again block COS

‘Go and have a look. Maybe the sewer of the first floor got blocked up again.’ [lit: ‘Let it not be the sewer of the first floor which got blocked up again.’]

The last morpheme is *kàn*, which originally means ‘to see’. The source of this apprehensive marker is the complement-taking verb *kán* ‘see’. Examples (7a) and (7b) illustrate, respectively, its verbal use and its apprehensive use in a threat.

(7) Standard Mandarin (Sinitic, Sino-Tibetan; Gao 2003)

- a. 我看他拿了几本书走了。

Wǒ kàn tā ná le jǐ běn shū zǒu le.

1SG see 3SG take PFV several CLF book leave COS

‘I saw him take several books and leave.’

- b. 再麻烦，看我带你到局里去!

Zài máfan, kàn wǒ dài nǐ dào jú li qu!

again bother APPR 1SG take 2SG go.to police.station LOC GO&DO

‘If (you) bother (me) again, I will take you to the police station!’ [lit.: ‘You’ll see that I will take you to the police station.’]

Similar apprehensive markers derived from ‘fear’ verbs, ‘see’ verbs and a prohibitive marker are also attested in Baoding, a non-standard variety of Mandarin spoken in Northern China.

2.2 A standard Mandarin-like strategy of apprehensive morphemes in Baoding

Baoding has two strategies for expressing apprehension. Firstly, Baoding may use markers grammaticalized from complement-taking verbs such as ‘to fear’, ‘to see’ and from the prohibitive morpheme, similarly to Standard Mandarin, as illustrated in (8a)–(8b).

(8) Baoding

- a. $T^h a^{45} p^h a^{51} t^h a^{45} p a^{51}$.
3SG fear 3SG father
'She is afraid of her father.'
- b. $U\gamma^{213} t e^{51} t s o^{51} t i p \gamma^{22} p^h a^{51} n i^{213} t \eta^{45-35} - t s o c i \tilde{a}^{22}$.
1SG deliberately do PAST tasteless APPR 2SG eat-STA salty
'I did (the meal) with less salt deliberately lest you find it too salty.'
[lit.: 'you eat it salty.']
- c. $c i \tilde{a}^{45} t c^h i^{51-45} k \gamma t i \tilde{a}^{51} x u a^{51}, p^h a^{51} t h a^{45} p \epsilon^{22} p^h \gamma^{213} i^{45-35} t^h \tilde{a}$.
first make CLF phone.call APPR 3SG in.vain run one trip
'Give (him) a phone call first, lest he goes there in vain (lest he has a wasted journey).'

As mentioned earlier, the verb *pà* or *kongpa* 'fear' in Standard Mandarin is grammaticalizing into a general potential modal adverb and is not a dedicated apprehensional marker. By contrast, grammaticalized $p^h a^{51}$ in (8b)–(8c), expresses both probability and undesirability, and functions as a dedicated apprehensional, namely a precautioning ('lest') clause.

The examples in (9) parallel the Standard Mandarin examples in (6). In example (9b), $pi\epsilon^{51}$ is no longer a prohibitive adverb as in (9a). Instead, it is used to express the speaker's wish or hope that an undesirable situation will not turn out to be true. In the same way, it concerns the speaker's fear that the undesirable event will take place.

(9) Baoding

- a. $P i \epsilon^{51} l \gamma^{213} n \gamma^{22} i a^{213-21} = l \epsilon$.
NEG_{PROH} always stay.late.at.night=COS
'Don't always stay late at night.'
- b. $T s \tilde{a}^{22} m \tilde{e} m \tilde{a}^{22} x u \gamma - l \epsilon p \tilde{a}^{51} t^h i \tilde{a}^{45} p i \epsilon^{51} i o^{51} p u^{45} t c^h i^{51-45} = l o$.
1INCL be.busy.with long.time APPR again NEG go=IRR
'We were busy with it for a long time. (I hope that it) won't be cancelled again.' [lit.: 'Let it not be the case that we don't go again.']
(Context: the two sisters have prepared their travel for a long time, however, the news announces storms in the next days. One of the sisters is getting worried.)

In a broad sense, $pi\epsilon^{51}$ in example (9b) has a 'negative optative' interpretation, that is, 'hope that it is not the case...'. The key factor for this interpretation is the

semantic feature of ‘control’: if the event is non-controllable, it means that the speaker worries about the potential occurrence of the undesirable event. If it is controllable, the marker has a prohibitive interpretation. The semantic interpretation of prohibitive vs. negative optative thus depends on whether the event is controllable or not.

Like Standard Mandarin, Baoding can also employ *khæ*⁵¹ meaning ‘to see’ to express an apprehensional function (in the broad sense). Example (10a) illustrates the use of *khæ*⁵¹ as a main verb, and (10b) illustrates its use in a threat:

(10) Baoding

- a. *Uɿ*²¹³ *tɕɛ*⁵¹ *kʰæ*⁵¹ *xuɿ*²¹³ *tɕio*⁵¹ *sue*⁵¹.
 1SG still see/read moment then sleep
 ‘I will do some more reading before going to sleep.’
- b. *Tɕɛ*⁵¹ *pu*⁴⁵ *lɔ*²¹³⁻²¹ *ʂ* *kʰæ*⁵¹ *uɿ*²¹³ *tɕɛ*²¹³ *mɿ* *ʂo*⁴⁵⁻³⁵ *ʂ* *ni*²¹³!
 continue NEG well-behaved APPR 1SG how punish 2SG
 ‘If you continue to be not well-behaved, (you will see) how I punish you!’

This function differs from the apprehensional-epistemic function and the precautionary function identified in Lichtenberk (1995), and may be termed a threat function (see Vuillermet 2018: 273). That is, if a condition is met, then the speaker will take a certain action that will be undesirable for the addressee. In that case, that action is usually controllable by the speaker.

Similar cases of apprehensional morphemes originating in morphemes belonging to comparable semantic domains, such as ‘see’, ‘look at’ or ‘watch’, ‘fear’ and prohibitive markers, are attested in some Australian languages and some languages in Austronesian family (as well as in classical Greek for the prohibitive marker, see Lichtenberk 1995). The link between prohibitive and apprehensive is also confirmed by Dobrushina (2006: 50–63), Pakendorf & Schalley (2007), and Smith-Dennis (2021), as well as by several contributions in this volume (Lahaussais, Treis, Wiemer).

In the following sections, we focus on another strategy of marking the apprehensive attested in Baoding: a final enclitic particle *=le.ia*, which is related to speaker vs. addressee involvement.

3 The apprehensive enclitic particle =*lɛ.ia* in Baoding and its functions

In my corpus of Baoding, the most common apprehensional strategy is the enclitic particle =*lɛ.ia* in clause final position, as shown in Table 1.

Table 1: Apprehensive expressions in Baoding

	Occurrence	Proportion
= <i>lɛ.ia</i>	40	81.63%
Other expressions	9	18.37%
Total	49	100%

3.1 Final enclitic particles in Baoding

Baoding, as many other Sinitic languages, possesses a large inventory of sentence-final or clause-final enclitic particles. These particles are often called *yuqici* ‘mood/modal particles’ in Chinese. They are referred to in English as “final particles” (Chao 1968: 149), “modal particles” (Chappell 1991), “utterance particles” (Luke 1990) or “sentence-final particles” (Li & Thompson 1981: 238). Some of these particles are considered discourse markers which do not carry any semantic content, and whose function is to convey a speaker’s attitude or other pragmatic information in a certain discourse context. However, the Baoding final enclitic particles also encode various TAME categories.

Before examining in detail the enclitic particle =*lɛ.ia*, we give below an overview of final enclitic particles in Baoding (Song 2020). Final enclitic particles are organized in three distinct paradigms. The first paradigm, situated at the position which is closest to the VP, includes two particles of associated motion. The second paradigm contains particles which are relevant to the TAME system. The third paradigm, in outermost position, is composed of particles that relate to illocutionary notions or to sentence types such as interrogative particles, as illustrated in example (11).

- (11) *Ni*²¹³ *kɛ̃*⁵¹ *ma*²¹³⁻²¹ = *tɕ^hi* = *lɛtso* = *ɛ*? *tsɿ*⁵¹⁻⁴⁵ *mɿ* *pɛ̃*⁵¹ *tiɛ̃*⁴⁵.
 2SG do.what=GO&DO=IPFV_{PAST}=INT_{WH} such long.time
 ‘What have you been doing for such a long time (away from here)?’

In (11), the enclitic particle $=tc^hi$ conveys the function of associated motion (motion-cum-purpose), and is followed by the enclitic particle $=letso$ which denotes an ongoing action in the past or a past state. The final interrogative particle $=\varepsilon$ typically appears in a wh-interrogative. These particles appear in a fixed order (slot 1, slot 2 and slot 3).

The apprehensive enclitic particle $=le.ia$ is found in the second slot. In example (12), $=le.ia$ is coalesced with the polar question particle $=\tilde{a}$, which belongs to the 3rd paradigm. $=le.i\tilde{a}$ is the result of the coalescence of $=le.ia$ and the interrogative $=\tilde{a}$, marking unexpectedness on part of the speaker.

- (12) $Ni^{213} tso^{213-21}=le.i\tilde{a}?$
 2SG leave=APPR.INT_{P.UNEX}
 ‘Are you leaving already?’ (Context: the speaker sees the addressee is packing his stuff and the speaker is surprised at his leaving, suggesting e.g. ‘Are you leaving without finishing your work?’)

Note that all the particles shown in Table 2 below are unstressed, i.e. they do not bear any contrastive tone. Furthermore, they trigger a tone sandhi on the preceding syllable. These prosodic features are typical of grammatical morphemes in Baoding.

3.2 The apprehensive enclitic particle $=le.ia$

Apprehensive is mainly expressed in Baoding through the final enclitic particle $=le.ia$. Its main function in terms of frequency is to solicit the addressee’s involvement in order to avoid a potential undesirable situation. The enclitic particle $=le.ia$ may indicate that the possible situation is unpleasant from the speaker’s point of view as illustrated in (13) below, a sentence uttered to warn the addressee that the bag of flour on the back of his bike is about to fall down.

- (13) a. $T^{hi}io^{213-21}=le.ia$, $t^{hi}io^{213-21}=le.ia$...
 fall=APPR fall=APPR
 ‘It’s falling!’
 b. $P\tilde{a}^{213} tci\tilde{e}^{213-21} tia^*$, $t^{hi}io^{213-21}=le.ia$.
 tie fasten a.little fall=APPR
 ‘Tie it up a little bit, it’s falling!’

In (13a) the imminent event of ‘falling down’ involves a high degree of certainty of occurring (unless someone does something about it) in the speaker’s view

Table 2: Final enclitic particles in Baoding

Paradigm 1: Associated motion		Paradigm 2: TAME		Paradigm 3: Illocution	
<i>tɕ^{hi}</i> GO&DO	Itive	<i>ni</i> CONT	Progressive aspect: ongoing action or state	<i>ā</i> INT _{P.UNEX}	Polar question: asking for confirmation of an unexpected event, mirative
<i>lɛ</i> COME&DO	Ventive	<i>lɛ/letʂo</i> IPFV _{PAST}	Ongoing action or state in the past	<i>ɛ</i> INT _{WH}	WH-question
		<i>lɛ</i> COS	Change of state	<i>pɛ</i> INT _{P.N}	Neutral polar question
		<i>ia</i> EGO	Imminent event (intention)	<i>pɛ</i> OBV	Obviousness
		<i>=lɛ.ia</i> APPR	Imminent event (undesirable)	<i>pa</i> INT _{P.CONF}	Polar question: expectation of confirmation
		<i>tʂo</i> PRI	Prioritive: do X first before the beginning of doing Y	<i>pa</i> ADVI	Advisative
				<i>ni</i> CTR.ASR	Counter assertion

and undesirability. With regard to the semantics of the apprehensive marker, the event denoted by the verb of the clause ended by *=le.ia* is always the apprehension-causing situation; the precautionary situation ('tie it up a little bit') is not expressed as part of the same clause as *=le.ia*. The enclitic particle *=le.ia* requests the addressee to do something. This can be expressed overtly, as in (13b), or this needs to be inferred, as in (14).

- (14) *cia*⁵¹*y*²¹³⁻⁴²*=le.ia*.
 rain=APPR
 'It is going to rain.' (If you don't hurry up, you might get wet.)

One of the main questions discussed in the literature is whether constructions such as (13b) should be considered complex sentences. Even though a pre-emptive clause can be added, as in example (13b), there is no reason to consider this as a complex sentence, since both clauses can appear independently. As claimed by Verstraete (2006: 222) based on a sample of twenty Australian languages, in constructions without relation markers, intra-clausal markers such as mood markers do not encode the complex sentence relation but contribute to a pragmatic interpretation of coherence between the clauses. Similarly, *=le.ia* in Baoding does not encode a complex sentence relation, and it only occurs in main clauses.

In addition to the apprehensive function, *=le.ia* also has a temporal function. The temporal function is observed when it co-occurs with activity verbs: it encodes an imminent future event. For instance:

- (15) *T^ha*⁴⁵ *tsu*⁵¹ *kuy*⁴⁵⁻³⁵*=ni* *t^ɕu*²¹³ *tci*²¹³⁻⁴² *tsɿ**=le.ia*.
 3SG put cooking.pot=CONT boil ravioli=FUT_{IMM}
 'She is putting the cooking pot on the fire. (She) is going to cook some ravioli.'

In the example above, *=le.ia* functions as an imminent future marker without any evaluative force of apprehension. The enclitic particle *=le.ia* only indicates that the event of 'cooking some ravioli' will occur in an imminent future after the utterance time. The apprehensive function is a semantic extension of the temporal one; this issue will be further discussed in §6.2.

One may think that in (13) the apprehensive interpretation is the result of the inherently negative semantics of the verb 'fall', rather than of the use of *=le.ia*. Nevertheless, we argue that it is the enclitic particle *=le.ia* that conveys the undesirability: the aspectual type of predicate generates differences in interpretation,

and an interpretation of undesirability with semantically neutral events is possible (see §4).

The aspectual type of predicate is one important parameter to distinguish the two functions of *=le.ia*. Predicates that co-occur with *=le.ia* can be activity verbs, change of state verbs, or some types of stative predicates such as nominal predicates. When the predicate is an activity verb, a temporal interpretation and an apprehensive interpretation are both possible, as in (15) and (16). The difference of interpretation is then triggered by the grammatical person, that is, first-person subjects trigger the apprehensive reading. This issue will be discussed in detail in §5.1.

- (16) U_s^{213} t_{su}^{213} $t_{\text{ci}\alpha}^{213-42}$ $ts_1=le.ia$, ni^{213} io^{51} s_l^{51} pu^{45} $xue^{22}-le$ t_{sh}^{45} .
 1SG boil ravioli=APPR 2SG if NEG come-DIR_{CTP} eat
 ‘If you don’t come back for dinner, I am going to cook some ravioli.’ (If you don’t come back for dinner, then I am going to cook only the ravioli, there will be no other dishes.) (Context: the speaker talks to her daughter on the phone. She implicitly requests that her daughter has dinner at home.)

Through this sentence, the speaker is warning the addressee about an imminent undesirable event. Note that the event of cooking ravioli, is not intrinsically undesirable. However, it is uttered in order to trigger a feeling of guilt in the addressee in (16): because of her absence for dinner, the speaker will only have ravioli for dinner instead of a more substantial meal. The speaker requires the addressee’s involvement (i.e., of not being absent) to avoid the undesirable situation, which is, cooking only ravioli for dinner. Note that the enclitic particle *=le.ia* in Baoding shares some similarities with the particle *na* in Ainu (see Tamura 2000: 176-177) in terms of requesting some actions from the addressee as shown in example (17).

- (17) Ainu (Isolate; Tamura 2000: 176)
Ape us na.
 fire extinguish SGST
 ‘The fire went out (so relight it).’

With change of state verbs, *=le.ia* systematically expresses undesirability. In example (18), we see that change of state verbs are compatible with the final enclitic particle *=le*, whose presence denotes the completeness of the change of state.

- (18) $T\dot{s}o^{45}$ $ci^{51-45}=l\epsilon$.
 porridge run.over=COS
 ‘The porridge has boiled over.’

In fact, predicates that are compatible with the final enclitic particle $=l\epsilon$ are also compatible with $=l\epsilon.ia$, and systematically trigger an apprehensive interpretation. (The issues of how $=l\epsilon$ relates to $=l\epsilon.ia$ and is even a possible source is discussed in §6.1.)

- (19) $Ku\tilde{a}^{45-35}-lo!$ $ku\tilde{a}^{45-35}-lo!$ $ci^{51-45}=l\epsilon.ia$.
 turn.off-COMPL turn.off-COMPL run.over=APPR
 ‘Turn it off! It is going to run over.’ (Context: the speaker asks her husband to turn off the fire, the porridge of millet is going to run over.)

With nominal predicates denoting a time reference of the day or special events or festivals on the calendar, such as $s\tilde{a}^{45}s\dot{l}^{22}$ ‘thirty’ (20), $s\dot{l}^{22}y^{51}ti\tilde{a}^{213-21}$ ‘12am’ (21), or $s\tilde{a}^{45}s\gamma^{22}$ ‘eve of the Chinese New Year’ (22), the only possible interpretation is apprehensive.

- (20) $S\tilde{a}^{45}s\dot{l}^{22}=l\epsilon.ia$.
 thirty=APPR
 ‘Beware you are going to be 30 years old.’ (If you don’t get married, it will be too late!) (Context: in this region, women are expected to be married before 30 / implied by the speaker: you will soon not be able to meet someone to get married.)
- (21) $s\dot{l}^{22}y^{51}ti\tilde{a}^{213-21}=l\epsilon.ia$.
 twelve o’clock=APPR
 ‘It will be 12am.’ (If you don’t prepare lunch, it will be too late.)
- (22) $S\tilde{a}^{45}s\gamma^{22}=l\epsilon.ia$, $x\epsilon^{22}me^{22}m\epsilon^{213-21}-s\tilde{a}pi\tilde{o}^{51-45}$.
 Chinese.New.Year’s.Eve=APPR yet NEG buy-RES ticket
 ‘It will soon be Chinese New Year’s Eve, (I) have not bought the train ticket (back home) yet.’

Example (22) seems to be an apparent counterexample to the overall claim that they solicit the involvement of the addressee. Here the addressee and the speaker are the same person: the speaker is talking to herself and solicits her own involvement.

Table 3 below shows the distribution of *=le.ia* collocating with different types of predicates in my corpus. Occurrences with activity verbs are infrequent: there are only six examples of this type, but as many as five of them do not have an apprehensional interpretation. This suggests that the occurrence with activity verbs, allowing for the most non-apprehensional interpretation, is much rarer. Change of state verbs and nominal predicates are probably the bridging context in Baoding that allow for the semantic reanalysis of *=le.ia* from an imminent future meaning to an apprehensive meaning.

Table 3: The distribution of *=le.ia* collocating with different types of predicates in my 40 hour corpus.

<i>=le.ia</i> collocating with ...	Occurrence	Proportion
... activity verbs	6	13.33%
... change of state verbs	30	66.67%
... nominal predicates	9	20%
Total	45	100%

The meaning added by *=le.ia* can also be described through a comparison with the egophoric enclitic particle *=ia*, used to mark a future event in (23b). Egophoricity is related to personal knowledge, experience or intention of the speaker. Baoding does not allow the speaker to talk directly about the internal state of others, such as their intentions, on the account of the fact that these are not directly perceivable to the speaker (see Song 2019).

- (23) a. $U_{\gamma}^{213} \tilde{s}\tilde{a}^{51} p\tilde{x}^{51} k\tilde{o}^{45} \tilde{s}l^{213-21} = t\tilde{c}^h i = \mathbf{le.ia.}$
 1SG go.to office=GO&DO=APPR
 ‘I am going to the office (I tell you in case you need me).’ (Context: the speaker is going to his office, before leaving, he talks to his wife.)
- b. $U_{\gamma}^{213} \tilde{s}\tilde{a}^{51} p\tilde{x}^{51} k\tilde{o}^{45} \tilde{s}l^{213-21} = t\tilde{c}^h \mathbf{ia.}$
 1SG go.to office=GO&DO.EGO
 ‘I am going to the office.’ (lit. ‘I am telling you that I am going to the office.’)

In certain cases, the addressee is meant to do something to prevent the apprehension-causing situation or mitigate for it. The example (23a), with *=le.ia*, implies a kind reminder ‘beware’: the speaker thinks that his leaving may be undesirable, because the addressee might need his presence. In other words, he

calls for a reaction of the addressee on his leaving, for instance by asking him to not leave. By contrast, the speaker using the particle *=le.ia* in (23b) only informs the addressee about his intention of leaving, without expecting it would cause inconvenience to his addressee. Example (23b) has a neutral imminent future interpretation, while (23a) does not. But it is the first-person subject which triggers the apprehensive reading with *=le.ia*. As will be discussed in §5.1, person is thus the second crucial factor in determining whether a sentence with *=le.ia* has an imminent future reading (just as the particle *=ia*) or an apprehensive reading.

4 Apprehensive particle *=le.ia* and relevant semantic features

This section analyses three main semantic features of *=le.ia* which support the analysis of *=le.ia* as an apprehensive marker: UNDESIRABILITY, INFERENTIAL EVIDENCE and IMMINENCE. The first and most important is undesirability. By adding *=le.ia*, even a semantically neutral or positive event can be presented as undesirable from the speaker's point of view.

- (24) $s\tilde{y}^{45-35}=le.ia!$ $s\tilde{y}^{45-35}=le.ia!$ $Ni^{213} x\epsilon^{22} l\tilde{y}^{51-45}-tso$
 give.birth.to=APPR give.birth.to=APPR 2SG still be.in.a.daze-STA
 $s\tilde{y}^{213-21} m\epsilon=ni\epsilon.$
 what=CONT.INT_{WH}
 '(She) is giving birth to a child! How come you are still in a daze?!'

In example (25a), the speaker accesses visually some evidence on the information of 'giving birth to a child' and urges the addressee to react. The way of access to the information may also influence the use of *=le.ia*; this issue will be discussed below. The event 'give birth to a child' is typically desirable. However, by adding *=le.ia*, the speaker conveys that (from their point of view) the consequence of the addressee not getting involved would be undesirable. That is, if the addressee does not get involved, then the person giving birth will soon be in danger. By contrast, if 'giving birth to a child' is expected and considered good news, then *=le.ia* is infelicitous (25a). An adverb is used instead and the enclitic particle *=le*, indicating a completed change of state (25b).

- (25) a. $\#s\tilde{y}^{45-35}=le.ia!$
 give.birth.to=APPR
 '(She) is giving birth to a child!' [as good news]

- b. $K^h\tilde{y}^{213} k\tilde{\epsilon}^{45} s\tilde{y}^{45-35} =l\tilde{\epsilon}!$
 finally should give.birth.to=cos
 ‘Finally (she) is giving birth to a child!’

Likewise, food getting cooked is a typically positive event. However, the context of (26) is the preparation of a dish where mung bean sprouts must be only briefly soaked in boiling water before being taken out. If left too long in hot water, they will be overdone and no longer crunchy. Thus ‘being cooked’ is undesirable in this case. The speaker requires the involvement of the addressee, ‘to take the mung bean sprout off the fire’ to avoid the beans to be (over)cooked.

- (26) $s\tilde{o}^{22} =l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia!$ $K\tilde{a}^{213} tci\tilde{\epsilon}^{213} tu\tilde{a}^{45} -lo!$
 cooked=APPR quickly take.with.both.hands-COMPL
 ‘(The mung bean sprouts) are going to be cooked. Take them off quickly!’

The second semantic feature of $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ which is relevant to its apprehensive meaning is inferential evidence, that is, the use of $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ is sensitive to information source. $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ marks that the information on the imminent event was acquired from inferred evidence. In (25a), the apprehensive $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ conveys inferential evidence which is not entailed by the imminent future semantics. By contrast, $=l\tilde{\epsilon}$ in (25b) marks that the speaker has been informed by a nurse, rather than inferred the event.

The literature on inferred evidentiality further distinguishes two subcategories, that is, the distinction between the inference made on the basis of sensory evidence and the inference made on the basis of assumption or general knowledge (see Aikhenvald 2004: 64, 174–176). In the case of Baoding, $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ can be used with both types of inferential evidence. The first type of inferential evidence concerns an inference made on the basis of sensory evidence, i.e. whether the speaker saw circumstantial evidence or has previous knowledge on an actual event or state. In the following examples, the use of $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ implies that the speaker’s information is inferred by visual/auditory/olfactory evidence: the vibration of the pot cover in (27) (repeated from 19), the dark clouds in (28) (repeated from 14), the pipe of the whistling kettle as in (29), or even a smell of burning as in (30). In this sense, $=l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia$ may be analysed as an inferential evidential.

- (27) $Ku\tilde{a}^{45-35} -lo!$ $Ku\tilde{a}^{45-35} -lo!$ $\epsilon i^{51-45} =l\tilde{\epsilon}.ia.$
 turn.off-COMPL turn.off-COMPL run.over=APPR
 ‘Turn it off! It is going to run over.’

- (28) $cia^{51}y^{213-42}=le.ia.$

rain=APPR

‘It is going to rain.’ (If you don’t hurry up, you might get wet.)

- (29) $K^h\epsilon^{45-35}=le.ia, k^h\epsilon^{45-35}=le.ia, tu\tilde{\epsilon}^{45}xu^{22}=tci=pa.$

boil=APPR boil=APPR take.with.both.hands.kettle=GO&DO=ADVI

‘(The water) is going to boil! Go and take it off the fire. (Otherwise it is going to overflow.)’ (Context: the speaker hears the pipe of the whistling kettle in the kitchen, but she cannot see it. She asks her husband to take it off the fire.)

- (30) $P\mathcal{J}^{45}kuy^{45-35}=le.ia, xuy^{213-21}s\tilde{a}tsuy^{51-45}-tso\ s^{213-21}m\gamma=ni\epsilon?$

burn.cooking.pot=APPR fire.above put-STA what=CONT.INT_{WH}

‘The (food in the) cooking pot is going to burn up. (I can smell it). What is on the fire?’

The second type of inferential evidence conditioning the occurrence of $=le.ia$ concerns evidence inferred through assumption based on general knowledge or based on the speaker’s experience with similar situations. In the following examples, the evidence comes from the speaker’s knowledge about an actual event or state. In (31a) (repeated from 20), the speaker is the mother of the addressee and knows her age. Similarly, in (31b) (repeated from 21), the speaker knows the actual state, that is, the present time.

- (31) a. $S\tilde{\epsilon}^{45}s\tilde{\eta}^{22}=le.ia.$

thirty=APPR

‘Beware you are going to be 30 years old.’ (If you don’t get married, it will be too late!) (Context: in this region, women are expected to be married before 30 / implied by the speaker: you will soon not be able to meet someone to get married.)

- b. $s\tilde{\eta}^{22}y^{51}ti\tilde{\epsilon}^{213-21}=le.ia.$

twelve o’clock=APPR

‘It will be 12am.’ (If you don’t prepare lunch, it will be too late.)

With an unpredictable event, an utterance with apprehensive $=le.ia$ in addition requires an epistemic downtoner such as the epistemic modal adverbs $k\epsilon^{45}$ ‘might’, as shown in (32):

- (32) $K^h_{y^{45}}$ $pi\epsilon^{51}$ $s\tilde{a}^{51}$ xe^{51} k_{χ} $ts\tilde{o}^{213}$ $s\tilde{l}_{\chi^{51-45}}=t\epsilon^h_i$, ni^{213}
 absolutely NEG_{PROH} go.to DEM_{DIST} CLF morning.market=GO&DO 2SG
 $t\epsilon^h_i\tilde{a}^{22}$ $p\tilde{o}^{45}$ $(k\epsilon^{45})$ $tio^{45-35}=l\epsilon.ia$.
 wallet might steal=APPR
 ‘Don’t go to that morning market, or your wallet might be stolen.’

In (32), the speaker has neither sensory or any other tangible base for the inference, nor any evidence about an actual event or state. The inference is made on the basis of the speaker’s experience with similar situations: ‘go to that market’ could be the cause of ‘having the wallet stolen’.

The third semantic feature relevant to the apprehensive meaning is concerned with imminence. The particle $=l\epsilon.ia$ cannot be used with general future time reference. Example (33) is ungrammatical due to the fact that $mi\tilde{\chi}^{22}$ ‘tomorrow’ is not compatible with the semantics of an imminent future.

- (33) $mi\tilde{\chi}^{22}$ cia^{51} $y^{213-42}=l\epsilon.ia$.
 tomorrow rain=APPR
 ‘It will/may rain tomorrow.’¹

To summarize, the semantic features of the enclitic particle $=l\epsilon.ia$ are [+UNDESIRABLE],² [+INFERENTIAL EVIDENCE] and [+IMMINENCE].

5 Interactions of $=l\epsilon.ia$ with other grammatical domains

In this section, we provide a brief account of how $=l\epsilon.ia$ interacts with person and speech acts, and look into the way it is interpreted in interrogative sentences, more precisely in polar questions.

5.1 The role of person

Besides aspectual verbal class, person is another important factor that triggers the apprehensive reading of a sentence with $=l\epsilon.ia$. We saw that $=l\epsilon.ia$ may encode imminent future without conveying any apprehension with activity verbs. But if they occur with a first-person/first-person plural exclusive³ or second-person subject, then $=l\epsilon.ia$ always conveys apprehension, as shown in example (34):

¹To express ‘It will/may rain tomorrow’, Baoding resorts to adverbs denoting epistemic modality such as pa^{45} $t\epsilon^h_{\chi^{22}}$ $s\tilde{l}^{51}$ / $p\tilde{o}^{213}$ $puz\tilde{u}\epsilon^{213}$ ‘maybe’.

² $=l\epsilon.ia$ has the feature [+UNDESIRABLE] with change of state verbs and nominal predicates, but not systematically with activity predicates.

³First person inclusive is not compatible with $=l\epsilon.ia$.

- (34) $Ts^h\epsilon^{22}$ tci^{213} $ti\tilde{\epsilon}^{213}$ $i\epsilon?$ Ni^{213} $t_s^h\iota^{45}$ $f\tilde{\epsilon}^{51-45}=l\epsilon.ia?$
 only how.many o'clock INT_{WH} 2SG have.meal=APPR.INT_{P.UNEX}
 'What time is it? You are already going to have your meal?'
 (Context: the speaker sees the addressee is taking out her lunch box and the speaker is surprised that the addressee does not wait for others and have lunch together.)

The verb $t_s^h\iota^{45}f\tilde{\epsilon}^{51}$ 'to have a meal' is an activity verb, but because it occurs with the second-person subject, the only possible interpretation is that of an apprehensive. The speaker suggests that having a meal now is undesirable by the addressee. The speaker implicitly asks the addressee to delay her meal, in order to avoid possible negative consequences. With a 2nd person subject, the apprehensional clitic often occurs in interrogatives. In this case its function is to question the addressee's awareness of a potential undesirable event (undesirable for the addressee or caused by them).

In (35) (repeated from 16), t_su^{213} 'to boil' is an activity verb which occurs with a first person subject. This eliminates the purely temporal reading and the only possible interpretation is apprehensive. The reading with 1st person subject can be considered as conveying emotional blackmail.

- (35) Uy^{213} t_su^{213} $tci\iota^{213-42}$ $ts\iota=l\epsilon.ia$, ni^{213} io^{51} $s\iota^{51}$ pu^{45} xue^{22} $-l\epsilon$ $t_s^h\iota^{45}$.
 1SG boil ravioli=APPR 2SG if NEG come-DIR_{CTP} eat
 'If you don't come back for dinner, I am going to cook some ravioli.' (If you don't come back for dinner, then I am going to cook only the ravioli, there will be no other dishes.) (Context: the speaker talks to her daughter on the phone. She implicitly requests that her daughter has dinner at home.).

As for third person-subject sentences, both the temporal reading (36) (repeated from 15) and the apprehensive (37) reading of $=l\epsilon.ia$ are possible with activity verbs. For instance:

- (36) T^ha^{45} $tsux^{51}$ $kux^{45-35}=ni$ t_su^{213} $tci\iota^{213-42}$ $ts\iota=l\epsilon.ia$.
 3SG put cooking.pot=CONT boil ravioli=FUT_{IMM}
 'She is putting the cooking pot on the fire. (She) is going to cook some ravioli.'
- (37) T^ha^{45} t_su^{213} $tci\iota^{213-42}$ $ts\iota=l\epsilon.ia$, $k^hu\epsilon^{51}$ $k^h\tilde{\epsilon}^{51}$ $k^h\tilde{\epsilon}^{51-45}=t\epsilon^hi$.
 3SG boil ravioli=APPR quick look.RED=GO&DO
 'She (Grandma) is going to cook ravioli. Go and have a look quickly!'

(Context: Grandma is very old and may hurt herself in the cooking process.)

The distinction between the two interpretations in the above examples is not clear-cut. Note that in a third-person subject sentence an imminent event cannot be expressed by the egophoric enclitic particle *=ia* which encodes an intention. The reason for this is that one cannot anticipate a third person's intention (an instance of the 'anticipation rule' discussed in Tournadre & LaPolla 2014). However, there is an exception when the third person is closely associated with the speaker, i.e. belongs to the personal sphere of the speaker. Example (38) illustrates the use of *=ia* in a third-person subject sentence:

- (38) A: $T^ha^{45} t\mathfrak{s}^hu^{45-35} -l\mathfrak{e}=l\mathfrak{e}=p\mathfrak{e}?$
 3SG exit- DIR_{CTP} = COS = $INT_{P,N}$
 'Has she already gone out?'
 B: $Me^{22}=ni, \quad t^ha^{45} t\mathfrak{s}\mathfrak{a}^{51} t\mathfrak{c}jo^{51} t\mathfrak{s}^hu^{45} t\mathfrak{c}^hia.$
 NEG=CTR.ASR 3SG soon exit.go.EGO
 'Not yet, she is going out soon.'

The context of the example (38) is that A is talking on the phone with B and asking her if her daughter is going out or not. As the third person in question here is B's daughter, their relationship is close enough to be considered as belonging to B's domain, the speaker B is therefore allowed to use the egophoric marker *=ia* as if she were talking about her own intention. However, this situation is relatively rare. Usually there is no opposition in third-person subject contexts as we found for first-person subject sentences in (23a) and (23b) (see §3.2 above). Unlike with a first-person subject, it is possible for *=le.ia* to have both a temporal function and an apprehensive function in the case of a third-person subject.

In sum, two parameters determine whether *=le.ia* has a temporal or apprehensive function: the verbal class, and the person of the subject of the sentence.

As claimed by Aikhenvald (2010: 225–226), the apprehensive may be considered as a special form of command. Table 4 lists the occurrences of *=le.ia* conveying undesirability with different grammatical subjects. It shows that in Baoding, the form most frequently occurs with an impersonal subject in uncontrollable events. This conforms quite well to the semantics of an apprehensive: such situations are frequently apprehension-causing.

No matter which person is the subject, sentences with *=le.ia* in its apprehensive function always convey an implicit request on the part of the speaker. In terms of pragmatic function, the speaker always expects the addressee to react

Table 4: =*le.ia* and person

	Occurrence	Proportion
First person subject	2	4.54%
Second person subject	10	22.72%
Third person subject	8	18.18%
Impersonal subject (in uncontrollable events)	24	54.54%
Total	44	100%

in order to confront the undesirable situation or to sometimes prevent its undesirable consequences. The speaker warns or reminds the addressee about the possibility of an undesirable event from his point of view which is going to occur. In (14), it is about to rain so the addressee should hurry or cover himself lest he get wet; in (26), (30), (29) the food will be overcooked, burned, or the water will run over, so the addressee should act to prevent these events to happen.

Even though when the event is undesirable for the speaker rather than for the addressee, as shown in (16), the implied meaning of the speaker is still that (s)he expects the addressee ‘to come back for dinner’ so that the speaker can avoid the undesirable effect of the event ‘cooking only the ravioli’ rather than a proper meal. It is about addressee’s involvement. To some extent, this is in accordance with Aikhenvald’s point of view in that utterances with =*le.ia* could be considered as a special form of command. More details concerning this issue will be provided in the following section.

5.2 The interaction with interrogative sentences

The behaviour of apprehensive markers in interrogative sentence types remains largely unexplored. To my knowledge, only Vallejos (2016: Chapter 12, cited in Vuillermet 2018), reports on a seemingly apprehensional morpheme in Kukama-Kukamiria (a Tupian language of Peruvian Amazonia) which mostly occurs in interrogative sentences. Apprehensives seem indeed infrequent in such sentence types and markers in both Baoding and Kukama-Kukamiria seem atypical in this regard.

In Baoding, the apprehensive =*le.ia* occurs in polar questions, and then encodes an implicit request to the addressee to prevent the undesirable event, as illustrated in (39).

- (39) $Ni^{213} tso^{213-21} = l\epsilon. i\tilde{a}?$

2SG leave=APPR.INT_{P.UNEX}

‘Are you leaving already?’ (Context: I see you are packing your stuff and I am surprised at your leaving: Are you leaving without finishing your work?)

In (39), the speaker considers the addressee’s leaving undesirable: he is expecting the addressee to stay longer in order to finish some work planned to be done together. The speaker is thus asking for confirmation that this unexpected, undesirable event is really going to occur. Compare with the following sentence:

- (40) $Ni^{213} tso^{213-21} = i\tilde{a}?$

2SG leave=EGO.INT_{P.UNEX}

‘Are you going to leave?’

In example (40), the speaker is surprised to see the addressee’s preparing to leave and asks him/her about his/her intention of leaving. The enclitic particle $=ia$ only encodes unexpectedness, with no apprehensional overtone or evaluative force from the part of the speaker.

The enclitic $=l\epsilon.ia$ can also occur in interrogative sentences with 3rd person-subjects (41).

- (41) $Tha^{45} tso^{213-21} = l\epsilon. i\tilde{a}?$

3SG leave=APPR.INT_{P.UNEX}

‘Is he leaving already?’ (without finishing his work)

In (41), the undesirable event is the inferred consequence of the person leaving. This consequence is considered undesirable for the speaker, but not necessarily for the addressee. The speaker is asking the addressee to confirm whether the leaving (and its unpleasant consequence) is going to happen. If so, then the addressee is expected to do something to avoid the negative effect likely to occur on the speaker. If the sentence is declarative, then the undesirable effect would be endured by the addressee (42).

- (42) $Tha^{45} tso^{213-21} = l\epsilon. ia.$

3SG leave=APPR

‘He is going to leave.’ (If you still need him, go and find him quickly.)

To conclude, the distribution of the enclitic particle $=l\epsilon.ia$ in interrogative sentences confirms the semantics of apprehension: regardless of whether the undesirable event is caused by the addressee or a 3rd person, the undesirable effect

is endured by the speaker in interrogatives, and by the addressee in declaratives. The expectation of a reaction likely to avoid or minimize the negative effect is always from the speaker's to the addressee's point of view.

6 Hypotheses on a possible source of *=le.ia* and on the semantic link between its functions

In this section, we give a hypothesis on a possible source for the apprehensive enclitic particle *=le.ia*, and propose a brief account of the semantic and pragmatic links between its temporal and apprehensive functions.

6.1 A hypothesis on the source of *=le.ia*

From a morphological point of view, *=le.ia* is a composite particle, which is likely constituted of two separate particles *=le* and *=ia*, both found in the second paradigmatic slot of final enclitic particles (see Table 2 above in §3.1). The particle *=le* 'COS' denotes a change of state (see example (21)), and the particle *=ia* 'EGO' expresses the intention of the speaker about an imminent future action (see §3.2).

Semantically, *=le.ia* could well be the synchronic product of the combination of the meaning of these two separate particles: a change of state in an imminent future. We can suppose that the undesirability interpretation is a later development, resulting in a request of involvement from the speaker to the addressee by adding an evaluative force or an overtone of apprehension: 'a change of state, which might be undesirable, is going to happen'. This fits quite well with the apprehensive meaning. In addition, semantic changes are often characterized by an increase rather than a decrease of subjectivity (Traugott 1989: 49).

Concerning the sources of the two particles *=le* and *=ia*, since earlier stages of the Baoding dialect are not documented, we can only base our hypothesis on what we know of the diachronic evolution of mainstream Mandarin Chinese and on a comparison with other varieties of Mandarin dialects spoken in Northern China, in particular those spoken in Shaanxi and Hebei. Although there are some divergences on the sources of final particles in Standard Mandarin, most scholars (Cao 1987: Chapter 3, Ōta 1987: 351, Liu 1985) agree that the source of the final particle **le**⁴ (cognate with *=le* in Baoding) is related to a verb **liao** [liǎo] meaning 'to finish'. The enclitic particle *=le* in Baoding is also pronounced as *=liε* by some speakers of the older generation (over 60 years old), which supports the same

⁴The transcription in Pinyin for Standard Mandarin is in bold letters.

origin. We can extrapolate that Baoding =*le* has gone through similar stages of development,⁵ and is the output of a monophthongization of the form =*lie*.

As for the second component =*ia*, based on a comparative study of the four editions of a colloquial Chinese textbook *Laoqida* in the Joseon period of Korea published from the 14th to 18th century, Takekoshi (2002) identifies two main functions of a sentence final particle *ye* [*ie*]: *a.* to mark a judgemental statement; *b.* to mark a change of state. The second function encompasses a change of state occurring in the past or the present and a change of state in the imminent future. This makes it a plausible candidate for the origin of the egophoric particle =*ia* in Baoding that expresses intention in an imminent future. A similar phenomenon is also found in the neighbouring Mandarin dialects and in Jin dialects spoken in Shanxi and Shaanxi (located at the west of Hebei), where an enclitic particle =*ia* can mark a future event (Xing 2002, 2005, Lü 1995, Shi 2004).

6.2 The semantic and pragmatic link between the temporal and apprehensive functions from a typological perspective

As shown in the literature on apprehensive constructions, the issue of the syncretism of apprehensive morphemes with other functions in many languages, and the link between their various functions, remains largely understudied.

We mentioned in §2.1 that the enclitic particle =*le.ia* has two functions in Baoding: the imminent future function when it combines with activity verbs, and the apprehensive function when it co-occurs with change of state verbs or nominal predicates. What we are interested in here, and try to clarify, is the semantic and pragmatic relations linking these two functions, by looking in the crosslinguistic and typological literature. Angelo & Schultze-Berndt (2016) show for instance that apprehensive morphemes can be historically related with a temporal morpheme, with evidence from a number of unrelated languages in the world. For instance, *nachher* ‘afterwards, later’ has developed an apprehensive function in colloquial German. A similar phenomenon is attested in Dutch with the temporal adverb *straks* ‘very soon, immediately’ and in several varieties of Kriol spoken across northern Australia (Boogaart 2009, 2020, Angelo & Schultze-Berndt 2016).

They argue for their observations with the ‘invited inferencing theory of semantic change model’ (Traugott & Dasher 2001: 34–40; Traugott 2006: 552–553):

⁵Northern varieties of Mandarin are nowadays quite similar to the language spoken during the Yuan Dynasty (1271–1368) (see Li et al. 2009: Chapter I). Baoding is not an exception. Thus, we can suppose that there are some similarities in the development of some grammatical morphemes between Baoding and Standard Mandarin.

a certain lexeme often used in a particular context can acquire the function of encoding another meaning by association with the inference invited by the speaker when it is linked with a certain conceptual structure. The inferred meaning then goes through a process of conventionalization and becomes the new meaning of this lexeme.

Such a path is plausible for *=le.ia* in Baoding. With regard to the semantic change from temporal to apprehensive, the inference invited by the speaker is that the event which is going to occur is considered undesirable. The change of state verb provides an ideal context for the apprehensive interpretation on account that change of state verbs convey that a new state or event is going to come about. The particle *=le.ia* acquires a new function through the reanalysis by the speaker in that context. When *=le.ia* is used with other types of predicates, such as activity verbs, it also acquires in some contexts and under some conditions (1st person subject) an apprehensive meaning, albeit retaining the temporal function in other contexts. As was claimed by Traugott (2006: 553), generally the new polysemy is distributionally different from the old one and a reanalysis has therefore occurred.⁶

7 Conclusion

We have shown in this paper that Baoding has a final enclitic particle *=le.ia* in apprehensive function: it conveys imminence and undesirability (from the speaker's point of view) and requests the addressee's involvement to avoid a potential undesirable situation. We also pointed out that apprehensive *=le.ia* can be used in polar questions. In this case, the speaker asks the addressee for confirmation of the unexpected and undesirable event, and implicitly requests him to prevent it.

We saw the relevance of grammatical person for the apprehensive reading: Baoding first-person subjects systematically trigger it. Person is thus a crucial factor determining whether a sentence with *=le.ia* has an imminent future reading or an apprehensive reading.

The apprehensive function of *=le.ia* can be considered the result of a semantic extension of its temporal (imminent future) function. The distribution of the two functions of *=le.ia* is shown to depend on the aspectual features of the predicates, and to a lesser extent, on the person of the subject. Cross-linguistic evidence (see

⁶Traugott gives an example of epistemic *must* in Modern English available in past tense and stative contexts, whereas the older deontic *must* in late Old English does not appear in the same contexts.

Heine & Kuteva 2002) has been presented in favour of the hypothesis that change of state verbs and nominal predicates are the bridging context in Baoding for the semantic reanalysis of *=le.ia* from an imminent future to an apprehensive function. This analysis is supported by the hypothetical origin of *=le.ia*: the change of state particle *=le* and the imminent future particle *=ia* have combined to denote an imminent change of state and later acquired an apprehensive meaning. Although it cannot be considered as grammaticalization in a narrow sense, what draws our attention in this process of giving birth to the apprehensive function of *=le.ia* is that the semantic reanalysis is accompanied by an increase of subjectivity, which confirms the unidirectional tendency identified by Traugott (1989).

Abbreviations

1SG	first singular personal pronoun	GO&DO	associated motion ‘go and do’
2SG	second singular personal pronoun	IPFV	imperfective aspect
3SG	third singular personal pronoun	INCL	inclusive pronoun
ADVI	advisative	INT _{WH}	WH type interrogative particle
ALL	allative	INT _{P.CONF}	polar question particle (with an expectation of confirmation)
APPR	apprehensive		
CLF	classifier	INT _{P.N}	polar question particle (neutral)
COME&DO	associated motion ‘come and do’	INT _{P.UNEX}	polar question particle (asking for confirmation usually unexpected)
COMPL	completive aspect		
CONT	continuous aspect		
COS	change of state	IRR	irrealis
CTR.ASR	counter assertion	LOC	locative
DEM	demonstrative	NEG	negative
DEM _{DIST}	distal demonstrative pronoun	NEG _{PROH}	prohibitive
DIR _{CTP}	directional centripetal	NIRR	non irrealis
EGO	particle expressing egophoricity	NSG	non singular
		O	object
EMPH	emphatic particle	OBV	obviousness
EVIT	evitative	PASS	passive
FACT	factitive	PAST	past tense
FUT _{IMM}	imminent future	POT	potential
		PRI	prioritive

R	realis	SG	singular
RED	reduplication	SEQ	sequential
RES	resultative	SGST	suggestion particle
S	subject	STA	stative

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